

would have earned. So, never think that the act of saving money is anything less than the act of earning more money.

If you have saved ₹100 in buying a shirt, you just earned ₹100 extra. That sounds more lucrative. Ultimately, it is this saved money that is going to contribute to your financial freedom savings, just as if you had earned an extra income.

Like most of us who do not understand the importance or the habits of a millionaire, I have suffered many times in my life because of impulse buying before I was financially educated on this aspect. I had signed up for many credit cards and club memberships (like Club Mahindra) just because of aggressive selling by the salesman. It is another matter that I had to later cancel my membership and take a refund (after losing some of the money.)

My wife and I took a pledge later that whenever we encountered any sales pitch where we had to buy "right now" or lose the opportunity, it would be empowering to be able to say no. And we have done this successfully now for more than 10 years.

Most people feel that they know what their expenses are, and they cannot reduce them anymore. They want to go on and enjoy life while on this journey. And I am 100% with them. We ought to make this journey beautiful, adorable and fully enjoyable, for success lies in the happy moments hidden in a journey towards a worthwhile goal.

Having said that, understand that it is a completely incorrect belief that reducing expenses would take away the charm and happiness from your journey. We are talking about reducing expenses that usually go as waste. We are talking about expenses that you are not even aware of. We are talking about making your daily life more efficient and productive in financial terms. This will not only help you reach your destination of financial freedom faster, but adding efficiency into your financial life will be a very fulfilling experience for you. I vouch for it from my own experience.

So, here are some simple practices that can help you reduce wasteful expenses: